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# Air

Taiwan's domestic airport network and the two carriers that operate it — the lifeline flights to outlying islands as much as the Taipei-Kaohsiung-Taichung trunk.

## Airports

Taiwan's domestic and international airports, from Taoyuan's main gateway to the outlying-island fields that exist because ferries alone cannot reach them fast enough.

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### Kaohsiung International Airport

The southern Taiwan gateway's history from a 1944 airfield to today's international terminal, with the runway dimension and MRT connection the operator states directly.

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### Outlying-island airports

Penghu, Kinmen, Matsu's two fields and the Taitung-served island strips at Lanyu and Green Island — each built or upgraded because the sea crossing alone was too slow, and each still running under the national island-fare subsidy.

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### Taoyuan, Songshan and Taichung airports

Taiwan's three main-island trunk airports outside Kaohsiung — one run by a dedicated state corporation, two flagged by the regulator itself as joint military-civil fields — with the runway and traffic detail their own sites would not surrender to a fetch.

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## Operators

UNI Air and Mandarin Airlines, the two carriers flying Taiwan's domestic network — both descended from smaller regional airlines absorbed into the China Airlines and EVA Air groups.

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### UNI Air and Mandarin Airlines

Taiwan's two domestic carriers, one descended from a 1996 rebrand and 1998 triple-merger under the EVA Air Group, the other a 1991 China Airlines joint venture — with different-sized route networks that do not fully overlap.

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Domestic aviation in Taiwan is two different businesses under one regulator. On the main island, Taoyuan, Songshan, Kaohsiung and Taichung sit inside a rail and highway network dense enough that flying between them is a convenience, not a necessity. For Penghu, Kinmen, Matsu, Orchid Island and Green Island, the same short-haul flights connect a sea crossing that can run several hours to a scheduled flight of well under one, and a standing national subsidy law prices those flights for island residents accordingly — see Airports [\[/air/airports/\]](/air/airports/) for the rates by route.

Start with Airports [\[/air/airports/\]](/air/airports/) for the network station by station — including the fare-subsidy law and CAA's own operating-loss subsidy scheme, covered on the outlying-islands page where they apply — then Operators [\[/air/operators/\]](/air/operators/) for UNI Air and Mandarin Airlines, the two domestic carriers, both descended from older regional airlines folded into the China Airlines and EVA Air groups.

This coverage sits alongside the site's rail, bus, ferry and bike-share sections rather than duplicating them: an outlying island's ferry service is covered under Ferry [\[/ferry/\]](/ferry/), and this section instead covers the transport some of those same islands depend on when the sea crossing is too slow, too weather-dependent, or both.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.